How to mix the colour and its shades

One grey? More like a large family. You can grade grey from almost white to almost black. In commonly called greys you also often find a tinge of blue, green, pink or beige.

On the palette it looks neutral, but next to a warm beige it suddenly looks bluish and next to another grey it may show a pink tinge. **Its look is influenced by light and neighbouring colours.** Make a sample and hold several colours up to it. Sometimes you do not need to change the grey itself, but the company in which you placed it.

What to prepare



White

The base of light greys.



Black

For simple grey mixtures and darkening.



Blue

For cooler, steely and bluish shades.



Sienna or orange

With blue it makes muted mixtures close to grey.



Ochre or brown

For warmer, stony and grey-beige tones.



Red or magenta

A small amount shifts grey to a pink or purple tinge.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

The simplest grey is mixed from white and black. **It is not the only way, though.** You can also get it by muting complementary colours against each other, for example blue and orange. Depending on the pigments the mixture may at first come out brown or tilted to one colour side.

For light mixtures start with white. **Black can take the lead faster** than its size on the palette would suggest.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens. Add black by the tip, not the other way round.





Black

Darkens and cools. It can take over the whole mixture, add by the drop.





Blue

Shifts toward steely and cold. A tiny dose is enough.





Sienna

Mutes blue into a quiet grey-brown tone. Add gradually.





Ochre

Shifts toward warm, stony and sandy.





Magenta

Shifts toward a pink and purple tinge. Only the tip of the brush.



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Ten greys to try

A part can be a drop, or an equally big heap of paint. The strength of pigments differs, so **take the ratios as a starting point for trying**.

Light grey



10 parts white and a really small addition of black. Light and soft.

Mid grey



Gradually add black into white according to the lightness required. Balanced and calm.

Anthracite



Black and a small amount of white, possibly a trace of blue. Deep and firm.

Blue-grey



White, a little blue and a tiny trace of orange to mute it. Cool and airy.

Warm stone



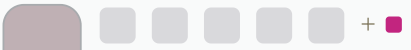
Light grey and a trace of ochre or brown. Soft and natural.

Grey-beige



White and a little brown, according to the result a trace of blue. Calm and homely.

Soft pink-grey



Light grey and a tiny bit of magenta or a cooler red. Tender and muted.

Violet-grey



White, purple and a very small amount of yellow. Dreamy and quiet.

Grey from colours



Adjust blue and burnt sienna into a muted mixture, then add white. Livelier than black and white.

Green-grey



Light grey and a tiny trace of green. Misty and fresh.

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